officers, show Macaulay's account to be substantially correct. Macaulay held the Dewan personally responsible for the 'atrocious murder', and declared that he would see him hanged. Now that he had nothing to lose, Velu Thampi Dalawa published what became known as the Kundaran Proclamation, calling on all the people of Travancore to unite in driving out the EICo. 'It is the nature of the English nation to get possession of countries by treacherous means,' his proclamation reads in part.

> Should they attain ascendancy in Travancore, they will put their own guards in the palaces, *Sircar* [government] buildings, and the fort gates, destroy the royal seal, and other distinguishing marks, suppress the Brahmanical communities and worship in pagodas, make monopolies of salt and every other thing, measure up and assert themselves absolute rulers of waste lands, impose exorbitant taxes on paddy lands [rice-fields], coconut trees etc, get low caste people to inflict heavy punishments for slight faults, put up crosses and Christian flags in pagodas, compel intermarriages with Brahman women without reference to caste or creed, and practice all the unjust and unlawful things which characterise *Kaliyuga* [the Dark Age].[10]

This stirring call to arms is why Keralans rightly honour the name of Velu Thampi Dalawa. It was answered by the disbanded Nair soldiery, who now rallied to his cause in large numbers. But Nair valour proved no match for the Company's better-disciplined troops, among them the men of the 12th Regiment of Foot, who took their revenge by surrounding the village where their comrades had been murdered and killing all its inhabitants, 'sparing neither young nor old'.